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Life on \$50 a Day

In the Dominican Republic they tell of a man who used to toss his fishing line into the deep waters of a splendid Caribbean cove. One day a tourist came by and asked what he was doing.

The fisherman, a descendant of sugar-plantation slaves, looked up. "I'm trying to catch a fish for my family's dinner."

"Why don't you fish a little longer, maybe catch two fish?" the tourist asked. "Eat one and sell one. In a short time you'd save enough money to buy a pole."

"What would I do with a pole?" the fisherman asked.

"Why, with a pole you can throw your line farther out. Just a few feet off shore you'd catch more fish. Sell the extra fish and pretty soon you'd save enough money to buy a boat."

The fisherman began to perk up. "What would I do with a boat?"

"You could row out into the cove," the tourist said, raising his voice a little. "Out there you'd catch even more fish. Pretty soon you'd save enough money to buy a second pole."